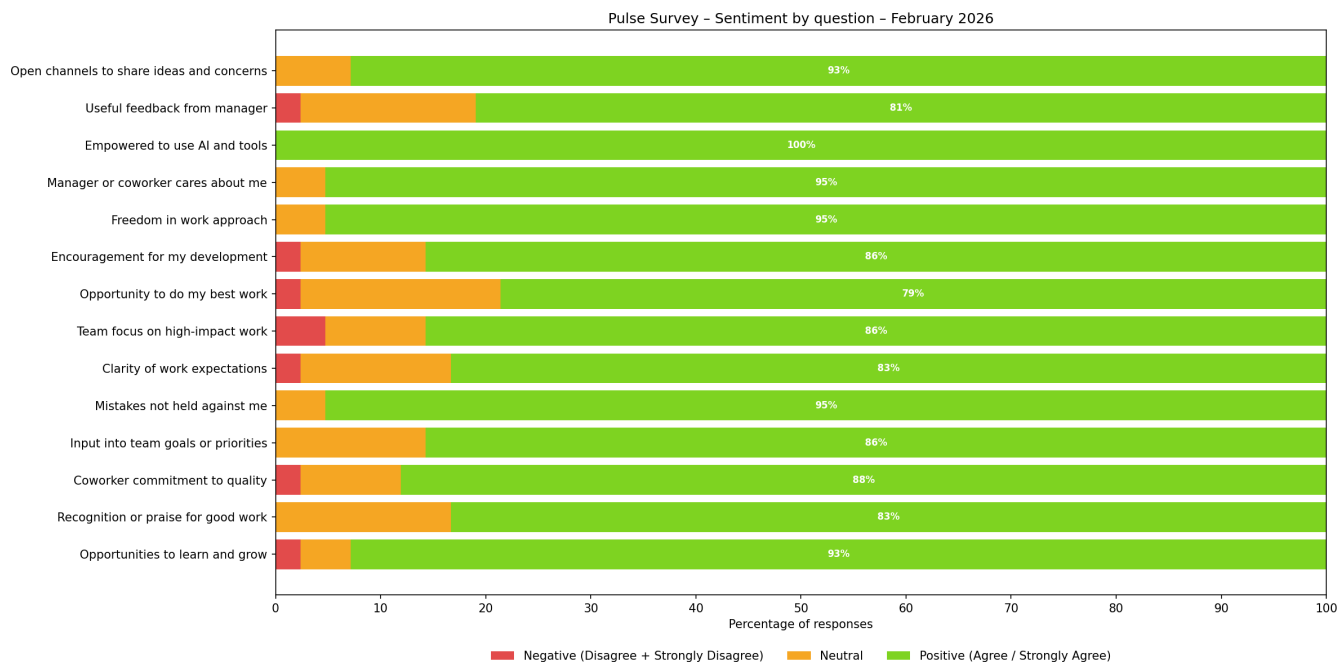
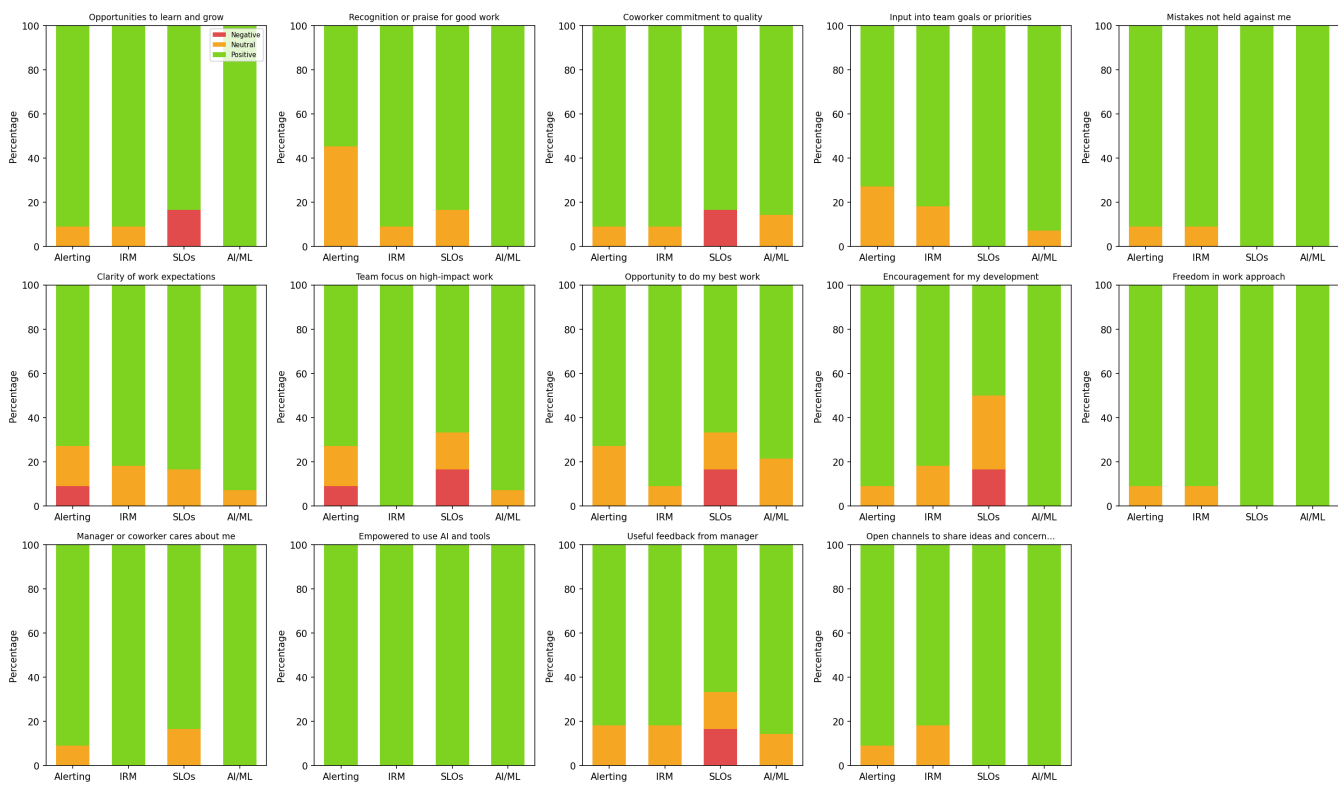


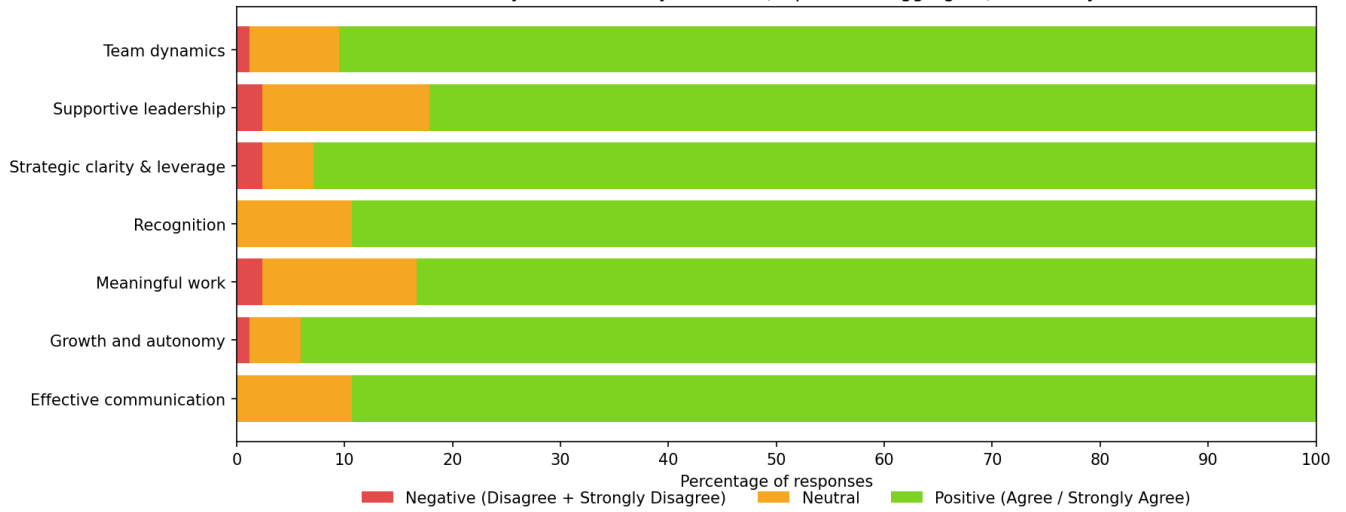
GOps Department Pulse Survey Summary – February 2026



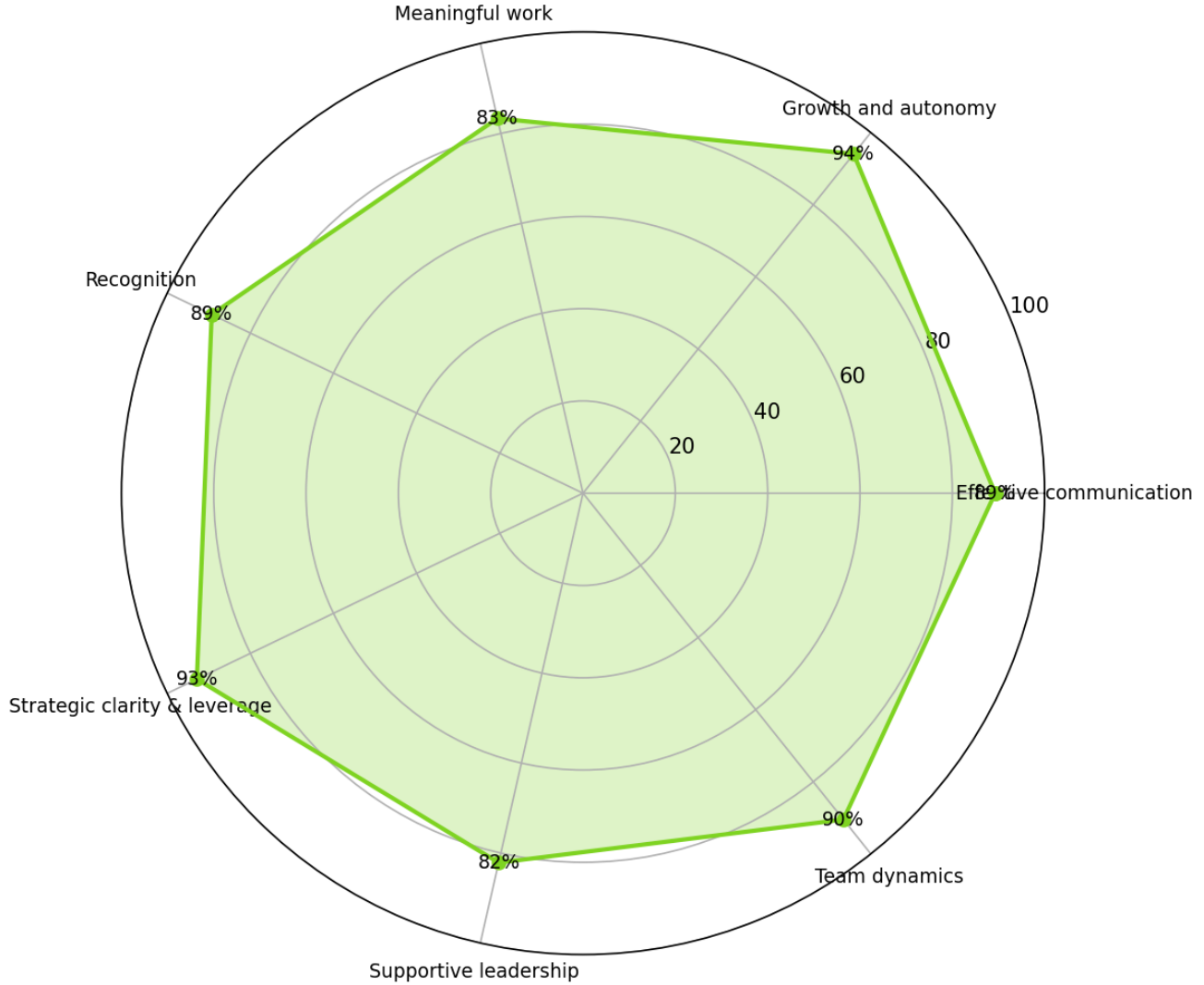
Pulse Survey - Sentiment by question and squad - February 2026



Pulse Survey - Sentiment by attribute (department aggregate) - February 2026



Pulse Survey - Positive % by attribute (radar) - February 2026



Optional comments (by sentiment)

Positive:

1. [AI/ML] A highly motivated team
2. [AI/ML] Yes, both from my manager & team members
3. [Alerting] Freedom is AI, right?
4. [Alerting] I have a very supportive manager who is invested in my enjoyment of work and opportunities to grow and improve. The work is engaging and challenging, and the whole team are generally very supportive.
5. [Alerting] I live on a diet of AI and AI enablement.
6. [Alerting] I love the flexibility and autonomy at Grafana, Engineers are trusted to manage our own work which I think really helps with motivation and productivity.
7. [IRM] I agree, manager is a very dedicated person towards our 1:1s
8. [IRM] I've had to shift focus from mostly just frontend to lots of infra work and some backend work also.
9. [IRM] Lots of people, our team is very encouraging and supportive
10. [IRM] My manager has been very involved on this front.
11. [IRM] Not someone, but the development budget definitely helps.
12. [IRM] People care about one another, want each other to do good work, and put in the time and effort to make things better around them
13. [IRM] Sort of cheating since I started about 6 months ago so it's been nothing but learning! But really, I've had opportunities to learn and grow, especially around adopting AI tools and taking on larger projects on IRM.
14. [IRM] The team and managers are supportive in my work.
15. [IRM] i think we handle this well
16. [IRM] we need to be bold and find a way to really make our product shine
i think everyone on the team agrees with this
17. [SLOs] I can work on AI projects, i'm empowered to increase my skills in my role, i feel the opportunities are out there for me if i want to take them.
18. [SLOs] In fact, I wish my coworkers were more comfortable with the tools - the main thing holding back additional uses for coding is out-pacing reviews by my team members.

Neutral:

1. [AI/ML] Could be a bit pushier here, it's fine
2. [AI/ML] I think it'd get pretty annoying if I were making a ton of mistakes others had to clean up. But we are definitely figuring some things out as we go.
3. [AI/ML] In AI, there is always something new to learn, it's finding the right thing to focus on which can be difficult.
4. [AI/ML] Maybe it's something at a different level but at this point I kinda have less concrete "expectation", but I get to define and shape the direction
5. [AI/ML] Mixed. With AI assisted coding, it's changing the way we work. We need to rethink and define how we ensure quality work.
6. [AI/ML] This is always a hard question. It's probably a good thing this isn't fully fixed, though I'd like to have more input on opportunities I might not be seeing.
7. [Alerting] Assuming that success looks like AI then yeah.
8. [IRM] A lot of it is running after customer requests, but there are places to develop as well.
9. [IRM] Everyone is fully committed, no doubts about this in the IRM department
10. [IRM] I feel like my thoughts on this may not be shared by everyone. While we strive for a blameless (or blame-aware) culture, it feels like folks are often hardest on themselves, especially around incidents.

Have we considered shifting our PIR process to require an outside observer to write the PIR and determine PIR actions? Typically they would review the artifacts, interview responders, and write up the PIR. While it can slow things down a bit, it helps decouple the incident from the follow up work and spreads the load and context around the team.

11. [IRM] I'm new to the team so my input is neutral as I learn more about the domain and priorities.
12. [IRM] Important to note that often you have to share what you're working on to get this! Posting in shared channels to celebrate wins is a must.
13. [IRM] Sometimes Agree, sometimes it's Strongly Agree, depends on projects mostly. I rated an average between these 2
14. [IRM] Sometimes it feels to me, that we take one or two short cuts too much.
15. [IRM] With our strong push towards AI it feels to me, that having doubts in this direction, doesn't feel to save any more to voice.
16. [IRM] i went all in on AI to really see how i can improve with it and i was nearing the budget limit for cursor, and then the budget was increased across the board, and no one has asked me to slow down - that feels very empowering to me
17. [SLOs] The staff+ expectations around breadth of impact continue to seem a little bit disjoint with regular cadence of squad work (i.e. hard to say no to enough regular work to have time to find breadth work)
18. [SLOs] We're changing focus too often and I don't feel that we as a team are driving our product forward. We have lost the engineering driven culture that has been so successful for Grafana.
19. [SLOs] it seems like expectations are changing and we're now expected to have higher velocity while also ensuring our squad work integrates with assistant (i.e. more going on, and expectation to move faster). I think some extra nuance or clarity around the velocity expectation could help here

Negative:

1. [AI/ML] A final thought that is on my mind but not shared in the form above: work-life balance has not been the same in the last year. At least for me, anxiety, work shifts, pressure, etc has all being growing up.
2. [AI/ML] I do feel empowered; it just does not make much sense to me to see this question as part of the feedback. I see this more as a pressure than as something to "increase my impact and help my team move faster"
3. [AI/ML] In this new age of AIs, I have a feeling that we are considering quantity more than quality.
4. [AI/ML] It's been tough getting Zed approved for reasons I don't fully understand, and I worry that "what we do" and "what the AI policy says" do not really match up very well.
5. [AI/ML] Some more than others, which I suppose is always true but it feels more extreme on both ends here? maybe this is AI's fault!
6. [AI/ML] There is a quite a bit of toil/maintenance which I don't think is evenly distributed amongst the team, and I end up spending quite a lot of time fixing or dealing with that rather than creating real value.
7. [Alerting] I'd like to better understand the long-term strategy for how Alerting and IRM should integrate. There's already some feature overlap, and I'm concerned that adding new features could create friction unless we define clear boundaries or a clear model for how the two areas should collaborate.
8. [IRM] I'm having trouble growing my skills on the team.
9. [IRM] So much AI!
10. [IRM] The mantra of "Go faster, use AI" as a repetition in meetings and syncs from folks who aren't using AI frequently feels frustrating. Everyone's already doing it, but it feels like continuous pressure of "just go faster" instead of understanding why we can't or what blockers we face that AI likely can't solve. Similarly, we're seeing more and more contributors outside of the team submitting PRs generated by AI to subvert the design process, shifting the work onto us to review and maintain.
11. [IRM] The pull between expert area and venturing to learn new things is sometimes difficult to juggle.
12. [IRM] There can't be other answer than Strongly Agree considering the spending limits we have for AI agents. Strongly agree, I appreciate this coming from Grafana
13. [IRM] We don't blame folks. When do we get to discuss how decisions were made? We often skip that part of the mistake.
14. [IRM] We don't make time for green field work very often
15. [IRM] We often state things are necessary but then are quickly deprioritized by external pressure
16. [IRM] We're being told frequently in channel "IHAC who wants..." or support comes in to go around the processes set up to help coordinate, which is a context switcher. Likewise, we're told "Just put it in AI" way too often as a means to success without understanding what

happens after that code is put into prod and has to be maintained.

17. [IRM] We're building newer tools for the team but we are both constrained by top-down pressure and unable to surface things we think are critical.

18. [SLOs] Putting out fires, having to hand hold junior engineers, constantly having to explain to the rest of the team technical and cultural ramifications of decisions.

19. [SLOs] Some members of the team are doing great work, the ones I work closest to are hesitant and afraid to take lead

Analysis

5 things working well

1. **Opportunities to learn and grow:** 93% positive responses indicate strong satisfaction with growth opportunities.
2. **Freedom in work approach:** 95% positive sentiment shows employees feel empowered in how they approach their work.
3. **Empowered to use AI and tools:** 100% positive responses highlight universal satisfaction with access to and use of technology.
4. **Coworker commitment to quality:** 88% positive feedback suggests a strong team focus on delivering high-quality work.
5. **Open channels to share ideas and concerns:** 93% positive responses demonstrate effective communication and openness within the department.

5 areas for improvement

1. **Recognition or praise for good work:** 17% neutral responses suggest some employees feel recognition could be more consistent or meaningful.
2. **Clarity of work expectations:** 14% neutral responses indicate room to improve how expectations are communicated.
3. **Useful feedback from manager:** 17% neutral and 2% negative responses show feedback quality and frequency could be enhanced.
4. **Opportunity to do my best work:** 19% neutral responses suggest not everyone feels fully enabled to excel in their roles.
5. **Supportive leadership:** 15% neutral and 2% negative responses indicate some employees may not feel fully supported by leadership.